

start than right now?

You know I love entrepreneurs. But if there is any doubt in your mind that the entrepreneurial life is for you, A is a wise karmic choice. Also, the big red flag for me is friends getting into business with friends. There is too much room for error, and for emotions to get in the way of business. Add money to the mix, in the form of a hefty investment, and you have a recipe for regret.

Option B isn't terrible, though. If you can invest in tiers, and only if you can afford it, being a silent partner in a growing business might be a way to diversify your investment portfolio. Still, proceed not only with caution, but with experts combing through their books. A proper due-diligence process is in order, no matter how reassuring your friends are. In fact, the more reassuring they are, the harder the accountants should be breathing down their necks. At any sign of financial dilemma, back out.

And if you picked C again, invest only if you have the money to completely lose. This is a gamble, period. And it's one you can afford to make only if it has little financial impact on your retirement plans or your family's future financial stability.